

Xenium comes to India

Philips re-enters mobile phone market in India with Xenium technology <http://bit.ly/n3mDBL>

The third wave

Samsung's Wave III handset set to arrive in the UK in October

Digit speaks to eCommerce web sites

Since we're talking a lot about shopping, deals and finding stuff online, we decided to get some info straight from some of the leading websites in this space

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d Based on last year's data, do online transactions actually spike during Diwali?

Kunal Bahl: There is a definite increase in the sales through online shopping during Diwali, but the spike is not as prominent as it would be in some of the categories offline.

Amarjit Batra: The spurt on OLX happens just before Diwali.

Manu Agarwal: Yes, it increases to 10-15 per cent in overall sales pattern.

d What are the most viewed or searched categories of products during this time?

AB: Household Goods like TVs, washing machines, furniture etc. and Personal Goods like mobiles and laptops. Other categories that see a spike are used and new motorcycles and cars.

KB: Mobiles and Electronics.

MA: Gifting items like Silver coins, Gold coins, Kitchen utensils and appliances, Cameras and Mobiles.

d What kind of offers will be available on your site during Diwali?

KB: To cater to the festive season, the focus will be on diamond jewellery, gold coins and other festive-related preferences of consumers.

MA: There will be bundle offers, lots of freebie distributions,



Amarjit Batra, Country Head, OLX.in

contests and prizes during this period. We'll run Shopping Fest during the OND Quarter across categories – Specially Gadgets and Gifts.

d How much do customers spend on average in a one-year period?

AB: Since we don't track the completion of transaction, because we only help the buyer and seller match their needs online, we can't say for sure on the

transactions pertaining to second-hand products. But, if you take a ballpark number of even 10 lakh people who sold their old (actual numbers will be much much higher as every individual would have a second-hand phone every year and some, every six months) phones last year, it's a sizable number.

KB:

The range is quite vast, since Snapdeal.

com customers have options to spend from as low as ₹400 to ₹40,000 in any given transaction, depending on type of deal.

MA: Around ₹7,000 - ₹10,000

d What are the most preferred modes of payment and from which regions?



Manu Agarwal, Founder & CEO, Naaptol.com

KB: Currently, the most preferred modes of payment are credit and debit cards, followed by net banking. Given the recent introduction of Cash on Delivery as an option for payment, the mix might change in the days to come.

MA: Prepaid modes are preferred. We'll be introducing Easy EMI options of three, six and nine months from October for Citibank and ICICI credit card holders. COD along with net banking and debit cards will also be available. Preferred regions are Tier I, II and III cities.

d Overall, what kind of trends are seen in consumer behaviour for consumer electronics and tech shopping?

AB: There are two clear trends emerging. Once a buying decision is finalised, consumers compare prices and research supply sources. Besides eCommerce sites, a portion of users also look at Free Classifieds sites for this.

The other emerging trend is an increasing number of tech shoppers going online to sell and buy second-hand goods.

KB: Post the first purchase, the probability and frequency of buying products online is pretty high. This is specially in categories like Electronics and Tech shopping. To drive this

first purchase, attractive offers and ease to the customer through multiple options for any category help.

MA: It's all about experience. If people are satisfied with the quality they do buy online. We need to target people with the kind of products they're looking for. We do lot of segregation while communicating with the customers based on buying patterns, browsing history, interest and other parameters. **d**



Kunal Bahl, Co-founder & CEO, Snapdeal.com